

SHEFFIELD SHIELD

Post-Match Tactical Review



NEW SOUTH WALES Home Side	VS	SOUTH AUSTRALIA Away Side
 DATE 08–11 October 2024	 VENUE Cricket Central, Sydney	 RESULT Draw

Executive Summary

366 NSW 1st Innings	260 SA 1st Innings	282/6 NSW 2nd Innings	309/5 SA Target Chase
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The Sheffield Shield fixture between South Australia and New South Wales concluded in a hard-fought draw, with South Australia successfully batting through the final innings despite sustained pressure from Nathan Lyon. The match was defined by contrasting individual performances — Sam Konstas' back-to-back centuries shaped New South Wales' dominance across the first three innings, while Alex Carey and Nathan McSweeney's resolute fourth-innings partnership ultimately denied them victory.

FIRST INNINGS — NSW BAT

New South Wales posted a commanding 366, built around **Konstas' 152**. He anchored the innings until the 288th run was scored, forming multiple crucial partnerships along the way. The most significant came with Josh Philippe, whose 56 contributed to a 140-run stand that gave New South Wales the platform to set a formidable total.

SECOND INNINGS — SA REPLY

South Australia responded with 260, with **Alex Carey's counterattacking 90 off 85 balls** providing the innings' most aggressive passage of play. However, **Nathan Lyon's** control and penetration — finishing with **5/47** — ensured South Australia fell short of the first-innings total, leaving New South Wales with a meaningful lead.

THIRD INNINGS — THE TURNING POINT

New South Wales pressed their advantage emphatically, declaring at 282/6 and setting South Australia a challenging target of 389. **Konstas** again proved the cornerstone, becoming the defining player of the match with his second century — a composed **105** that demonstrated both his consistency and temperament under pressure.

FOURTH INNINGS — THE DRAW

The final innings appeared to be heading towards a New South Wales victory when Lyon's opening spell reduced South Australia to 23/4. What followed, however, was one of the most disciplined batting performances of the match. **Carey and McSweeney constructed a pivotal 182-run partnership**, blending contrasting styles to neutralise Lyon and outlast the New South Wales attack. Their centuries — **Carey's 111** and **McSweeney's unbeaten 127** — ensured South Australia batted through the remaining overs and secured the draw.

The outcome was shaped by two defining individual contributions pulling in opposite directions: Konstas' back-to-back centuries built an insurmountable target, while Carey and McSweeney's fourth-innings partnership dismantled it. Together they created the stalemate that made a draw the only possible result.

Phase Analysis

Run Rate by Phase

The bar chart highlights how run rates evolved across each innings and phase. New South Wales consistently outscored South Australia in their respective first innings, with their third-innings 51+ phase producing the highest run rate of the match at 4.31. Both teams struggled most in the 1–20 phase, with South Australia's fourth innings being the most dire at just 1.71. Run rates generally increased through the phases, reflecting typical batting progression as batters settled.

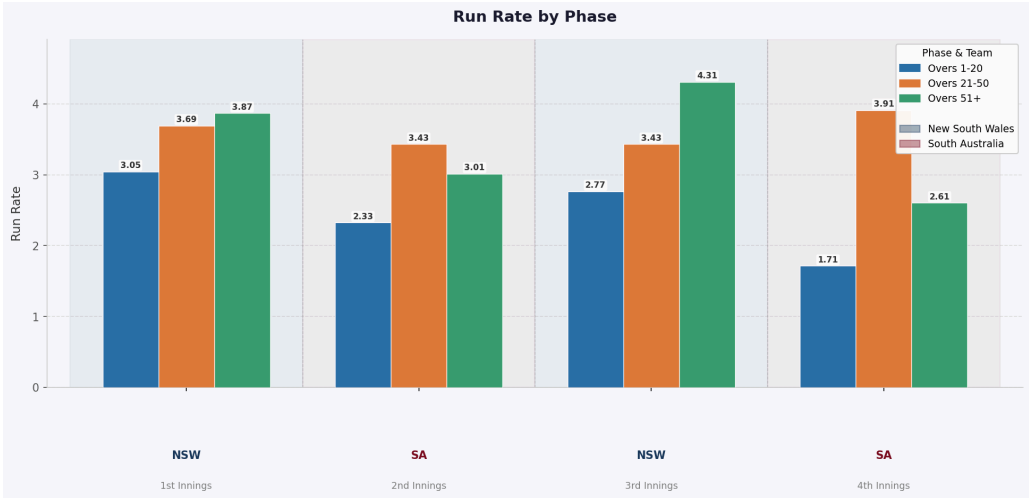


Figure 1 — Run rate by phase across all four innings

Dot Ball Percentage by Phase

The heatmap reveals that dot ball pressure was heaviest in the 1-20 phase across all four innings, with South Australia's fourth innings recording a suffocating 84.9% — the darkest cell on the chart. Dot percentages consistently declined as overs progressed, indicating batters found more scoring opportunities in later phases. New South Wales' third innings showed the greatest improvement, dropping to just 56.9% in the 51+ phase. Overall, South Australia conceded more dot balls when batting, suggesting sustained bowling pressure throughout the match.

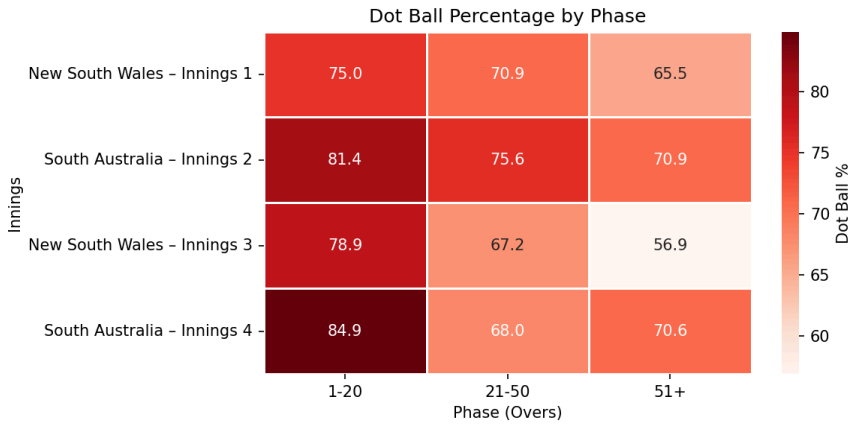


Figure 2 — Dot ball percentage by phase across all four innings

Spell Impact Analysis

Bowling spells were defined as continuous overs bowled by the same bowler, separated by at least one over from another bowler. Each spell was ranked using a composite impact score designed to reward wicket-taking while accounting for scoring suppression and sustained pressure.

$$\text{Impact Score} = (\text{Wickets} \times 2) - \text{Economy Rate} + (\text{Dot \%} \times 2)$$

Top 3 Highest-Impact Spells of the Match

innings	bowler	spell_id	start_over	end_over	overs	runs	wickets	balls	dot_pct	economy	impact_score	batting_team
4	NM Lyon	1	1	23	12	31	3	72	80.56%	2.58	5.03	South Australia
1	N McAndrew	6	83	93	6	10	2	36	83.33%	1.67	4.00	NSW
2	NM Lyon	3	58	78	11	23	2	66	72.73%	2.09	3.36	South Australia

Table 1 — Top 3 ranked bowling spells by impact score

Nathan Lyon’s Match-Shaping Spells

Nathan Lyon was the most influential bowler of the match, delivering decisive spells in both South Australia innings that repeatedly threatened to swing the contest in New South Wales' favour.

In the second innings, Lyon was at his miserly best, finishing with 5/47 at an economy rate of 1.92. His most damaging passage came in the middle order, where he removed the dangerous Alex Carey — who had been counterattacking freely at 90 off 85 balls — before dismissing Daniel Drew for a duck in the same over to trigger a collapse. His control throughout prevented South Australia from building any sustained momentum, ultimately restricting them to a total 106 runs below New South Wales' first-innings score.

Lyon was equally threatening in the fourth innings, where his opening spell reduced South Australia to 23/4 and briefly made a New South Wales victory look probable. He removed CJ McInerney for a duck before dismissing Nathan McAndrew and Travis Head cheaply, applying suffocating pressure through a dot ball percentage of around 80%. Across his 12 overs he claimed 3 wickets at an economy of 2.58, and while Carey and McSweeney's partnership ultimately denied him a match-winning haul, Lyon's sustained control was central to everything New South Wales built in the field throughout the contest.

MATCHUP BREAKDOWN — LYON 1ST SPELL VS SA BATTERS IN THE 4TH INNINGS

batter	balls	runs	dots	boundaries	singles	wickets	dot_pct	boundary_pct	single_pct
N McAndrew	18	2	17	0	0	1	94.44%	0.00%	0.00%
NA McSweeney	17	11	12	1	2	0	70.59%	5.88%	11.76%
TM Head	12	9	9	2	1	1	75.00%	16.67%	8.33%
AT Carey	10	7	7	1	1	0	70.00%	10.00%	10.00%
CJ McInerney	9	0	9	0	0	1	100.00%	0.00%	0.00%

Table 2 — McAndrew matchup data during his 4th innings spell

The matchup data reveals just how effectively Lyon neutralised the South Australian top order in the final innings:

- CJ McInerney faced 9 deliveries without scoring before being dismissed for a duck, setting the tone for the early pressure applied by Lyon.
- Travis Head faced 12 balls and managed to score two boundaries, but was eventually clean bowled by a high-quality delivery. His dismissal provided a significant psychological boost for New South Wales, given his experience and ability to counterattack.
- Nathan McAndrew faced 18 deliveries, 17 of which were dot balls, before being dismissed for just 2 runs, illustrating the level of control Lyon maintained during the spell.

Batting Impact Analysis

Sam Konstas' centuries in both innings were the primary force behind New South Wales' dominance across the first three innings. His contributions established the scoring platforms that allowed New South Wales to maintain scoreboard pressure throughout and ultimately set a target beyond South Australia's reach. Yet it was the fourth-innings response from Nathan McSweeney and Alex Carey that proved equally match-defining — their centuries rescuing South Australia from the precarious position of 23/4 and steering them to a hard-fought draw.

Each batting performance in this analysis was assessed using a composite impact framework built around four factors: the proportion of team runs contributed, runs scored during collapse phases — defined as three wickets falling within 15 balls — partnership contribution, and dot ball control. This structure is designed to isolate innings that genuinely shaped match outcomes, rather than simply rewarding volume scoring in favourable conditions.

Top 4 Highest-Impact Innings

Innings	batting_team	batter	runs	balls	strike_rate	dot %	team_run %	runs_in_collapse	max_partnership_runs	impact_score
4	SA	McSweeney	127	283	44.88	69.26%	41.91%	1	69	0.65
3	NSW	S Konstas	105	226	46.46	72.12%	38.46%	1	41	0.59
1	SA	S Konstas	152	241	63.07	67.22%	44.31%	0	79	0.54
4	NSW	AT Carey	111	158	70.25	63.92%	36.63%	0	111	0.50

Table 3 — Top 4 batting innings by impact score

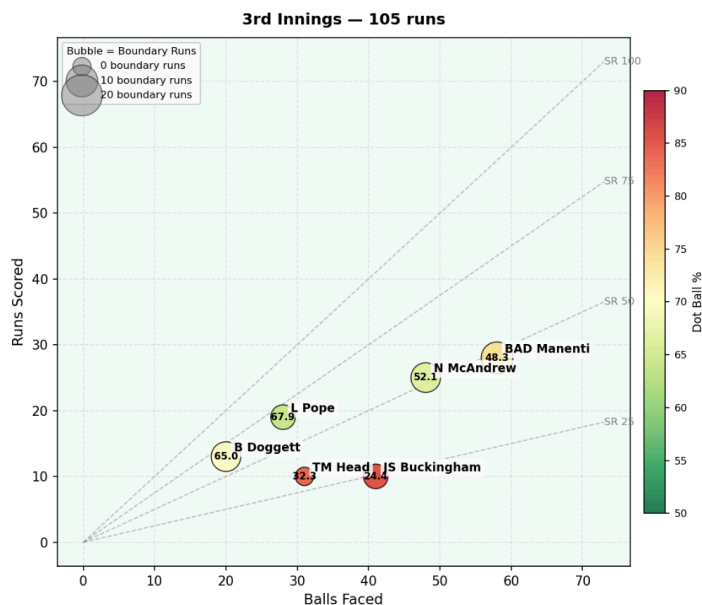
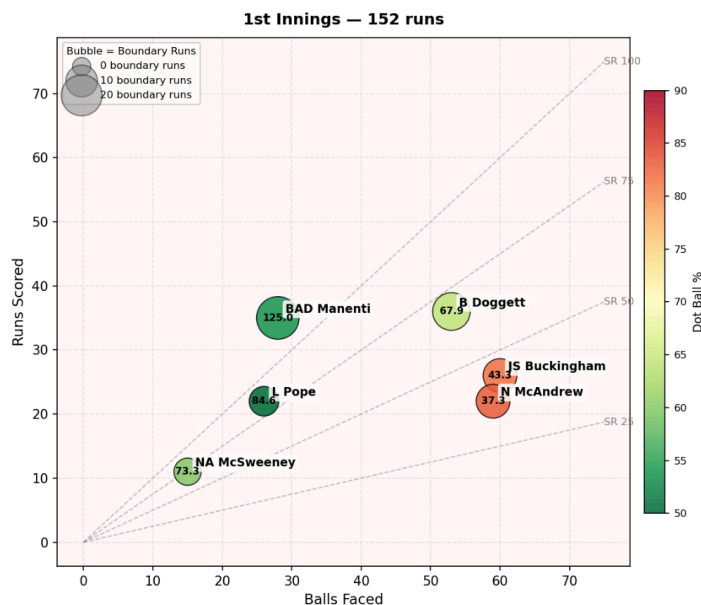
Sam Konstas — 152 (241) and 105 (225)

Sam Konstas’ centuries in both innings were the standout performances of the match and ultimately earned him the **Player of the Match** award.

His **152 in the first innings** set the tone for the contest, providing New South Wales with a strong platform and early scoreboard pressure against South Australia. He faced JS Buckingham (60 balls) and Nathan McAndrew (59 balls) most frequently, but also played most cautiously against them with a dot % 78%. Against Brendan Doggett, however, he was more productive, scoring 38 runs off 53 balls and rotating strike effectively with 13 singles. Konstas was most aggressive against Manenti, scoring 35 runs off 28 balls with four boundaries.

He backed his 1st innings ton with another ton by scoring 105. He faced **Manenti (58 balls)** and **McAndrew (48 balls)** most frequently, scoring steadily while maintaining dot ball percentages around 66–74%, indicating a controlled innings built through accumulation rather than boundary hitting. Against **Buckingham**, he scored **14 runs off 41 balls**, showing his willingness to absorb pressure when required. Konstas was most productive against **Manenti**, scoring **28 runs** while rotating strike effectively. His innings was eventually ended by **Lloyd Pope**, the only bowler able to dismiss him across the two innings.

Sam Konstas — Runs Scored vs Balls Faced per Bowler



Konstas demonstrated the hallmarks of a match-defining player — dominant in favourable matchups, disciplined under pressure, and relentless in accumulation across two innings. His ability to back a first-innings century with another in the third, against the same attack and under renewed pressure, underlines a temperament and skill set well beyond his years.

Fourth Innings Resistance — Carey, 111 (158) & McSweeney, 127* (283)

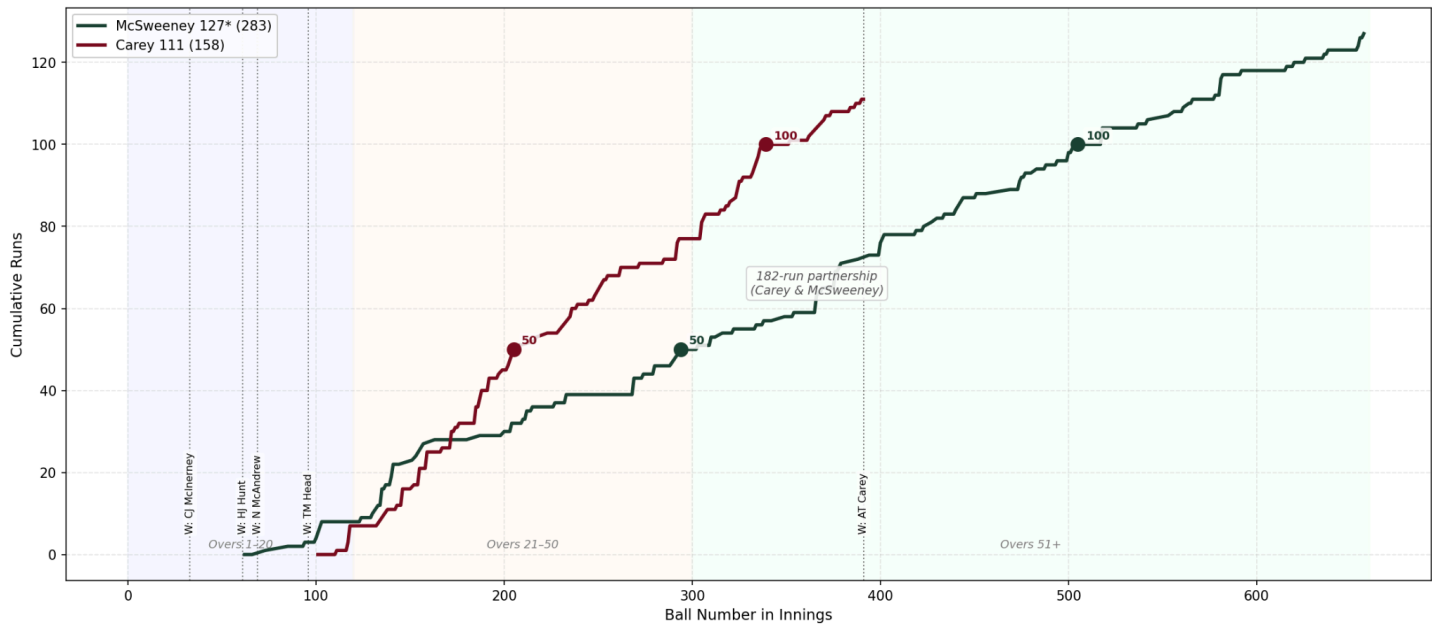
Had it not been for the fourth-innings heroics of **Alex Carey** and **Nathan McSweeney**, this match would likely have been a comfortable win for New South Wales. Their partnership ultimately ensured South Australia were able to save the game.

McSweeney arrived at the crease when South Australia were **9/3 under immense pressure**. He showed exceptional discipline, particularly against **Nathan Lyon**, facing **91 deliveries** from him and largely opting to negate the threat, playing **67 dot balls with only one boundary**. McSweeney scored more freely against the seamers, making **32 off 47 balls against Liam Hatcher** with three boundaries and sixteen singles, and **19 off 22 against Jack Edwards**. His composure allowed him to anchor the innings as he **remained unbeaten at the end of the match**.

Carey came to the crease shortly after at **23/4** and joined McSweeney in building a crucial **182-run partnership**. Unlike McSweeney, Carey looked to counter Lyon by scoring against him, making **33 off 52 balls** with four boundaries, eleven singles, and three doubles. This contrasting approach helped relieve pressure and stabilise the innings.

South Australia's run rate dropped from **3.9 in the middle phase to 2.6 in the final phase**, as Carey and McSweeney recognised that chasing the target was unrealistic with the tail to follow and instead focused on safely batting out the draw.

4th Innings Batting Progression — Carey & McSweeney



— End of Report —